

Design Review Report

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Teaching Videos

List each teaching video you watched. For each one, write a real takeaway. What concept clicked for you? What surprised you or challenged an assumption you had? What impressed you about how your teammate demonstrated something? Take this seriously. Your teammates put real effort into these videos to teach you something you did not study yourself.

Video

I watched **Esther's** video on **currentColor**.

Takeaway

What stood out to me from Esther's video was how useful `currentColor` can be for keeping components consistent and easier to maintain. Before watching the video, I understood that colors could be reused with custom properties, but I did not realize that `currentColor` automatically uses the element's text color and can be applied to borders, shadows, SVG icons, and other properties. The demonstration showing how changing a single color value automatically updated the border and other visual elements helped the concept click for me.

I was also impressed by the examples showing how `currentColor` reduces repetition in CSS. Instead of defining the same color multiple times, a component can inherit the current text color and stay synchronized automatically. This connects to my own work because I often repeat color values throughout a component. Using `currentColor` would make my code cleaner and easier to maintain, especially when creating buttons, badges, or icons that need to match surrounding text colors. The video helped me better understand when to use `currentColor` for contextual styling and when custom properties are still the better choice for fixed design values.

Code Reviews

Review at least two teammates' Practice Site repositories. Look at their actual code for Choose Topic pages you did not build yourself. Each design review you should choose different teammates to review so that over the course of the semester you cycle through everyone on your team.

Review

I reviewed **Esthers's** code for their **Practice Site visual effects** page.

What You Found

One thing I noticed in the code that did not fully come through in the video was how much she combined multiple techniques on the same page. Her page includes the required visual effects, but she also added a “Blend Modes & Shape-Outside” section, which uses both `shape-outside: circle(50%)` and `mix-blend-mode` concepts together. I thought that was clever because it showed the technique in a more realistic layout, not just as a small isolated demo.

I also noticed that her structure was organized clearly. The page links to her shared `dist/styles.css`, includes her theme toggle, and keeps the visual effects sections separated in a logical order: hero, cards, glass panel, icons, and then the choose-topic section. I did not notice anything major that was broken when reviewing the page. One thing I would want to learn from is how she explained the blend mode and shape-outside section directly on the page, because it made the purpose of the effect easier to understand. It reminded me that a demo page is stronger when the code effect and the written explanation work together.

Review

I reviewed **James Wright**'s code for their **Blend Modes** page.

What You Found

One thing I noticed that was not immediately obvious from the page itself was how many different blend mode examples he included. Instead of only demonstrating a single blend mode, he organized the page into several examples that allowed me to compare how each mode affects an image. I thought this was helpful because it made it easier to understand the differences between the effects and when each one might be useful in a design.

I did not notice any major errors or broken styles while reviewing the page. The layout was easy to follow and the examples were clearly labeled. One thing I appreciated was how focused the page was on the topic. Rather than adding a lot of extra styling, the design emphasized the blend mode demonstrations themselves. This helped keep the page organized and made the effects easier to evaluate. Reviewing the page gave me a better understanding of how blend modes can be used to create different visual moods without needing multiple versions of the same image.

Check In

How Are You Doing?

Overall, I am feeling pretty good about the course material so far. The assignments have helped me become more comfortable with modern CSS features such as custom properties, Lightning CSS, relative color syntax, and visual effects. I especially enjoyed learning how to organize CSS using layers and components because it makes larger projects easier to manage.

One area I would like to understand more deeply is when to choose between different advanced CSS techniques that seem to accomplish similar goals. For example, understanding the tradeoffs between different color functions, visual effects, and newer CSS features in real-world projects would be helpful. Other than that, I feel like I am keeping up with the material and gaining practical skills that I can apply to future web development projects.

My team has been participating and providing feedback on discussion posts and reviews. At this time, I do not have any concerns about team participation that I feel need to be brought to your attention.